North Ridgeville dethrones Olmsted Falls

Rangers take three titles on way to championship

Steve Byrne
The Chronicle-Telegram

OLMSTED FALLS — North Ridgeville will bring a team trophy back to the high school and send three sectional champions to the Division II district tournament next weekend.

The Rangers, in only their second season wrestling at the Division II level, dethroned five-time defending champion Olmsted Falls to capture the title in one of the closest sectional tournaments at Olmsted Falls in recent memory.

North Ridgeville had 194.5 points to Falls' 189 and Buckeye's 184.

"The kids rose to the occasion," North Ridgeville coach Ed Haller said. "I told them all they had to do was wrestle to their capabilities and they had a chance to win this thing.

"They did that. If they got dumped, they just came right back and won their next ones. They did that all day."

Josh Bement at 112 pounds, Matt Schultz at 130 and Brad Jarrett at 189 took crowns in their respective weight classes.

None was more dramatic than Jarrett's battle against Kiel Miller of Revere. Miller was ahead 6-0 midway through the second period and had Jarrett on his shoulders, ready to take him down for two more points.

But something unusual happened. When the two struck the mat it was Miller who suddenly found himself on the bottom. Jarrett needed only eight seconds to complete the pin.

"I caught him with a chin whip," Jarrett said. "He was manhandling me, but I always look for that chance to use something like that."

"Stuff like that happens sometimes," Haller said. "It's happened to us in the past. But when Brad pancakes his man he usually pins him. He's strong, and it's hard to get up when he's pancaked you."

The pin pushed North Ridgeville past Falls in the standings. The Bulldogs had one more shot to overcome the Rangers, but Justin Funk, a 215-pounder wrestling at 275, lost to Holy Name sophomore Joe Bucha in the championship match.

North Ridgeville will take eight to the district tournament at Firestone High School in Akron, including two seconds, two thirds and a fourth. Olmsted Falls will have nine, with one champion, three runners-up, two third and two fourths.

"We had a lot of tough matches this afternoon to get nine (to the finals)," Falls coach Bill McGrain said. "Maybe we lost our edge. We did not wrestle real well tonight. But as poor as we were, we still had a chance to win it. We'll all be ready to bounce back next week."

Falls' only champion was Kyle Stoffer at 103 pounds. Stoffer, a junior, kept himself unbeaten through 31 matches this season with a 9-6 decision over Ricky Randazzo of Padua.

Bement, a sophomore, improved to 28-3 by sailing past Padua's Kurt Gross 19-7. Schultz, the only other undefeated wrestler at the Olmsted Falls tournament, went to 28-0 with a 4-3 decision over Mike Gross of Falls.

Brent Lawton of Avon Lake was the only other champion from the area. Lawton, a senior, improved to 24-5 with a 3-1 victory over Jeremy Rudy of Ridgeville.

Also heading to the district from North Ridgeville will be Matt Rabung (103), Sean Minter (119), Jeremy Kowalewski (215) and Greg Powell (275).

Falls wrestlers Rush Williams (119), Paul Adkins (135), Ian Grimaldi (152), Kenny Jones (160), Justin Carver (171) and Aaron Blomquist (189) will join Stoffer, Gross and Funk at the district.

Avon Lake also advanced Matt Howard (125), Ryan Fankhauser (152), Mike Keegan (171) and Brent Gantz (215). Going to the district from Bay will be Jon Stan at 112 and Aaron Gomoll at 125. Firelands and Brookside failed to advance anybody.

DIVISION II SECTIONAL WRESTLING

TEAM STANDINGS

1. North Ridgeville 194.5, 2. Olmsted Falls 189, 3. Buckeye 184.5, 4. Parma Padua 170.5, 5. Fairview 162, 6. Norton 135.5, 7. Avon Lake 101, 8. Highland 85, 9. Holy Name 75.5, 10. Rocky River 68, 11. Bay 61.5, 12. Firelands 37, 13. Revere 33, 14. Copley 30, 15. Brookside 14.

CHAMPIONSHIPS

103 — Stoffer (OF) dec. Randazzo (Pad), 9-6; **112** — Bement (NR) dec. Gross (Pad), 19-7; **119** — Fowler (Bu) dec. Minter (NR), 7-2; **125** — Moody (Bu) dec. Gomoll (Bay), 13-5; **130** — Schultz (NR) dec. Gross (OF), 4-3; **135** — Lawton (AL) dec. Rudy (NR), 3-1; **140** — Durkin (Pad) dec. Glaba (Fa), 21-8; **145** — Turchin (Nor) dec. Spahn (RR), 20-9; **152** — Vanni (Hi) dec. Ute (Nor), 7-1; **160** — Incorvaia (Hi) dec. Jones (OF), 9-5; **171** — Harmon (Nor) dec. Han (Fa), 25-10; **189** — Jarrett (NR) pinned Miller (Rev), 3:11; **215** — Yates (Nor) dec. Gantz (AL), 15-1; **275** — Bucha (HN) dec. Funk (OF), 10-3.

CONSOLATIONS

103 — Rabung (NR) dec. Kissinger, 11-6; **112** — Boyes (Bu) dec. Stan (Bay); **119** — Weight (Fa) pinned Williams (OF), 3:56; **125** — Becka (Pad) dec. Howard (AL), 4-0; **130** — Randazzo (Pad) dec. Kish (Fa), 10-2; **135** — Meyers (Bu) dec. Adkins (OF), 9-5; **140** — Tuttle (Cop) dec. Majestic (Hi), 7-5; **145** — Westhovan (HN) dec. Mawhinney (Bu), 8-6; **152** — Fankhauser (AL) def. Grimaldi (OF), default; **160** — Keho (Pad) dec. Milano (RR), 5-2; **171** — Carver (OF) dec. Keegan (AL), 7-4; **189** — Blomquist (OF) dec. Salutrec (Bu), 2-1 OT; **215** — Campea (Pad) dec. Kowalewski (NR), 5-3; **275** — Powell (NR) dec. Cullen (Bu), 5-3.

Elyria survives Comets

Pioneers build big advantage, have to hold on

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — For whatever reason, Elyria High's basketball team cannot stand the prosperity of a big lead this season.

Saturday, in front of a decent Senior Night crowd, the Pioneers were on the verge of routing Amherst before finishing with a nailbiting 54-47 victory. Elyria is now 11-8 on the year, opposite Amherst's 8-11 mark.

BOYS BASKETBALL

"For the life of me, I don't know why we went away from what we were doing," said John Srnis, Elyria's coach.

Elyria doubled the Comets' output, 30-15, 3½ minutes into the second quarter. The Pioneers were moving the ball well on offense, finding the open looks and burying the shots. Elyria was nine of 16 the first quarter with just a single turnover.

However, after Paul Kothe hit his third trey of the night that gave the Pioneers the 15-point spread with 4:30 left, Elyria scored only two more points in the half.

"First quarter, we knew we had to get in their face," said Amherst coach Dave Zvara. "They shot the ball well — we knew they'd shoot the threes. Our defense wasn't that strong. We played better defense the second half."

"We stopped moving the ball — stopped moving ourselves," said Srnis. "The key when we were playing well — we kept it off the ground (dribbling). On defense, we ran our match-up very well at the start. We talked well and we pressured them pretty well."

It brought visions of the Elyria Catholic game at the Holiday Classic when the Pioneers nearly blew a 20-point first half lead, or even as recent as Friday when Elyria raced to an early 8-2 lead at Mentor but couldn't maintain the pace. There have been other examples all year long but Srnis cannot put his finger on the problem.

"We weren't real happy the way we finished tonight," said Srnis. "We didn't change anything. I don't know why we stopped doing the things we were doing."



TOM MAHL/CHRONICLE

HAMMING IT UP: Elyria's Dwayne Ham (left) dribbles while looking for an opening in the Amherst defense Saturday night at Elyria. The Comets' Nick Quarando is at right.

Six-foot-5 senior Jordan Scarbrough, starting for the first time in a half-dozen games, sparked the offense with several baseline jumpers. Scarbrough finished with 10 points joining classmates Jayson Bendik (12) and Paul Kothe (11) in double figures for Elyria. Dwayne Ham, the fourth senior starter, added six points after becoming the first EHS player in memory to sing the National Anthem in uniform.

"I didn't know he had a voice," said Scarbrough of his teammate. "Ham's very talented.

"Senior night, you got to get pumped up for the game. The baseline shot's my favorite. As long as the team wins, it doesn't matter what my role is."

"We could have quit," said Zvara. "They could have put us away. We had good help off the bench. Right now, we just want to end up on a positive."

Amherst, with Mike Hamilton scoring 10 points off the bench and Derek Goodwin and Zack Crowther combining for 25 in their starting roles, made a game of it the second half. The Comets had the margin cut to 49-45 but Bendik stole a pass stopping an Amherst possession and Eric Sims' trey on the other end sealed the verdict with 1:44 left.

Ryan McClure's junior varsity won its 15th game in 19 tries with a 50-31 victory over the Comets. C.J. Elliot and Marcus Washington led the way with 18 and 10 points respectively.

The Pioneers wind up regular season and Lake Erie League play at Shaker Heights Friday before preparing for Cloverleaf at the Division I tournament the following Wednesday at Midview. Amherst finishes with Fairview Friday before tackling North Olmsted in the tournament opener the following Tuesday.

ELYRIA (54)

Players	GA	G	FA	FT	F	TP
Jayson Bendik	11	5	0	0	2	12
Paul Kothe	7	3	2	2	1	11
Jordan Scarbrough	9	5	0	0	3	10
Steve Medvetz	4	1	2	2	2	6
Dwayne Ham	5	3	0	0	3	6
Melvin Pickens	3	2	0	0	2	4
Eric Sims	2	1	0	0	0	3
Jesse Lattea	2	1	0	0	0	2
Antonio Ward	0	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	43	21	4	4	13	54

AMHERST (47)

Players	GA	G	FA	FT	F	TP
Derek Goodwin	9	3	8	7	0	13
Zack Crowther	13	5	0	0	2	12
Bobby Madison	3	2	0	0	4	4
Paul Schneider	2	1	0	0	0	2
Matt Wolfe	1	0	0	0	2	0
Mike Hamilton	13	5	2	0	0	10
Nick Quarando	2	2	0	0	0	4
Chris Schoen	3	1	0	0	1	2
Adam Hamilton	2	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	48	19	10	7	9	47

Score by Quarters

	1	2	3	4	T
Elyria	21	11	7	15	—54
Amherst	9	12	12	14	—47

3-point goals: Elyria (6-15) — Kothe (3-5), Bendik (2-7), Sims (1-2), Pickens (0-1). Amherst (2-12) — Crowther (2-7), Hamilton (0-2), Schneider (0-1), Wolfe (0-1).
Rebounds: Elyria 24, Amherst 26.
Turnovers: Elyria 14, Amherst 12.
Junior Varsity: Elyria 50-31.

Columbia edges EC to take fourth place

Jerry Henson
The Chronicle-Telegram

BROOKLYN — Columbia's Raiders had no individual champions or runners-up but led area teams with a fourth-place total of 135 points as the Division III sectional wrestling tournament concluded Saturday night at Brooklyn High School.

The Raiders had four finish in third place and another two who were fourth as they bested fifth-place Elyria Catholic by four points. The Panthers had two individual champions in the 13-team competition, which sends its top four finishers to the upcoming district at EC.

"This was a good way for us to finish up," said Columbia coach Merle Dusek. "Our kids decided to come out and wrestle. I really felt good about the finals. Even our fifth- and sixth-place kids did a good job for pride, if nothing else."

Nate Lieux (135) got the first Elyria Catholic individual championship when he upset Cuyahoga Valley Christian Academy's Brett Smilek 4-1 in their finale. With all of the scoring coming in the second period, Lieux got an escape, penalty point and takedown while Smilek could muster only an escape.

"Nate's match was one heck of a match," said EC coach John McNulty. "He wrestled how he had it planned. Smilek was rated as the second-best in the state."

Heavyweight Kurt Wilhelm capped things off for the Panthers with a 58-second pin of CVCA's Paul Borbely. From the start, Wilhelm aggressively attacked his opponent and allowed him a single escape after his first takedown. He got a second takedown and two near-fall points before his pin.

"I'm really happy with what we did here," said McNulty. "This is only a warm-up for what's coming at our place. Things should be interesting at the district.

"I'm extremely proud of what anyone from our area did. Those getting out of here deserve to be out of here. I'm really glad for anyone from our area who advanced."

Keystone's undefeated Jim Pycraft (152) captured the area's only other individual championship, improving his unblemished mark to 37-0 with a 5-3 decision over Jared Adams of Bedford Chanel.

Pycraft and Adams struggled through a scoreless two periods before Pycraft started the third period in the down position. Adams let him escape before the Wildcat junior quickly got a takedown. After Adams escaped, Pycraft took him down once again; and Adams made things interesting when he got a late reversal.

"He (Adams) gave me a run for my money," said Pycraft. "I kept my head and didn't get behind. I was mad when he kicked me out and allowed me to escape. I thought he should have tried to ride me. This feels pretty good."

Cuyahoga Valley Christian Academy had four individual champions and took home the team championship with 238.5 points, overcoming first-day leader Bedford Chanel. Metropolitan Area Conference champion Cuyahoga Heights stayed in third place, completing a trio of 200-plus point scorers.

"Our guys put together a good tournament," said CVCA coach Dave Bergen. "It's really nice to win, but we know we have a lot of tuning up to do between now and the district."

DIVISION III SECTIONAL WRESTLING

FINAL TEAM STANDINGS

Cuyahoga Valley Christian Academy (CVCA) 238.5; Bedford Chanel (BC) 229; Cuyahoga Heights (CH) 213; Columbia (COL) 135; Elyria Catholic (EC) 131; Avon (A) 110; Keystone (K) 72; Independence (I) 59; Clearview (C) 55; Oberlin (O) 38; Brooklyn (B) 36; Lutheran West (LW) 13; Cleveland Central Catholic (CCC) 12.

CHAMPIONSHIP RESULTS

103 — Matt Smilek (CVCA) dec. Chris Burrer (K), 8-2; **Third:** Adam Lint (CH) major dec. Jeff Monsman (BC), 8-0

112 — Paul Charvat (CVCA) major dec. Charlie Welling (A), 13-2; **Third:** Chris Kostel (CH) dec. Justin Hicks (BC), 2-0

119 — Harry Lester (CVCA) major dec. Mario Fernandez (EC), 13-2; **Third:** Dan Ralph (BC) dec. Derek Meyers (CH), 6-2

125 — Jim Stanek (BC) tech. fall Teddy Branham (C), 18-3; **Third:** Matt Sammons (CVCA) major dec. Chris James (EC), 14-2

130 — Joel Foote (CH) dec. Don Holztrager (K), 5-1; **Third:** Mike DeJesus (C) dec. Brad Sanderson (CVCA), 10-6

135 — Nate Lieux (EC) dec. Brett Smilek (CVCA), 4-1; **Third:** Denny Pajestka (CH) major dec. John Orlosky (BC), 14-1

140 — Tom Schaefer (BC) pinned Dave Meyers (CH), :51; **Third:** Marc Drellishak (A) pinned Mike Coljohn (I), 3:31

145 — Mike Rizzo (CH) dec. Jarrad Turner (CVCA), 10-3; **Third:** Sam Chappell (COL) dec. Nick Roppel (BC), 7-0

152 — Jim Pycraft (K) dec. Jared Adams (BC), 5-3; **Third:** Keith Hamman (COL) dec. Matt Sorace (CH), 8-7

160 — Matt Klinger (CH) dec. Kevin Hoogenboom (BC), 5-1; **Third:** Brad Fredonia (I) pinned Chris Steinmeyer (COL), 4:14

171 — Chris Smolk (CVCA) dec. T. Terry (BC), 9-3; **Third:** Ray Anthony (COL) major dec. Andy Cash (CH), 12-2

189 — Tom Kekelis (CH) pinned Andy Ucker (CVCA), 3:52; **Third:** Greg Luman (C) won by default over Robert LoConti (I)

215 — Mark Zaranec (BC) major dec. Scott Borthwick (EC), 12-4; **Third:** Brian Logan (COL) pinned Jon Schindler (A), 4:19

275 — Kurt Wilhelm (EC) pinned Paul Borbely (CVCA), :58; **Third:** Alan Dallide (BC) pinned Ryan Cox (COL), 2:26

Columbia beats Avon in thriller

COLUMBIA STATION — Columbia's Doug Olivero blocked a 3-pointer by Eric DeChant with about three seconds left in the game to preserve a 57-56 victory over Avon Saturday night.

Joe Waldecker had hit a basket with about 18 seconds left to give the Raiders the 57-56 lead. DeChant had an awesome fourth quarter, hitting six 3-pointers and scoring all of the Eagles' 18 points.

He finished with 31 points that included seven 3-pointers. DeChant started the game off by hitting a 3-pointer. Chris Mandock chipped in 12 for the Eagles, 1-17.

Jeff Truelson led Columbia, 13-7, with 17 points. Waldecker had 14 and Angel Cordero added 13.

BOYS BASKETBALL

Avon	G	F	T
Pasendek	2	0	4
Stencil	2	1	6
Logan	1	0	2
DeChant	11	2	31
Mandock	6	0	12
Henry	0	1	1
Totals	22	4	56

Columbia	G	F	T
Truelson	5	7	17
Olivero	4	0	9
Cordero	4	3	13
Wyman	1	0	2
Augaitis	1	0	2
Waldecker	7	0	14
Totals	22	10	57

Points by quarters

	1	2	3	4	T
Avon	7	16	15	18	— 56
Columbia	9	17	13	18	— 57

Three-point goals: Avon — DeChant 7, Stencil; Columbia — Olivero, Cordero 2.
Junior varsity: Avon, 45-18.

Ad. King 56, Toledo Rogers 49

LORAIN — The Admirals outscored Rogers 21-9 to pull out their ninth win against nine losses.

Matt Rositano, the nephew of coach John Rositano, and Lebron Massey each scored 13 points and Ryan Simmons and Dennis Johnson each added 11 for King.

Rogers	G	F	T
Bond	0	4	4
Short	3	0	6
Williams	1	1	3
Campbell	4	0	8
Awis	7	1	15
Harrison	2	4	8
Totals	18	11	49

Admiral King	G	F	T
Chapman	3	0	6
Richardson	1	0	2
Simmons	4	3	11
Johnson	4	1	11
Massey	5	3	13
Totals	21	9	56

Points by quarters

	1	2	3	4	T
Rogers	13	16	11	9	— 49
Admiral King	9	15	11	21	— 56

Three-point goals: Rogers — Short 2; King — Rositano 3, Johnson 2.
Junior varsity: Admiral King, 52-42.

Southview 78, Whitmer 60

TOLEDO — Scott Remaklus scored 30 points, 17 of them from the free-throw line, as the Saints improved to 14-5 on the year.

"It was a good win in preparation for the tournaments, we're very pleased," said Southview coach Larry Stark.

Southview	G	F	T
Lighty	4	3	11
Remaklus	6	17	30
Rivera	1	0	2
Rios	5	3	15
Scott	2	0	4
Todd	1	0	2
Torres	2	2	6
Collins	4	0	8
Totals	25	25	75

Whitmer	G	F	T
Fletcher	3	2	8
Alexander	4	4	13
Bannister	0	1	1
Veres	4	1	11
Barre	7	9	23
Hill	1	2	4
Totals	19	19	60

Points by quarters

	1	2	3	4	T
Southview	16	13	21	28	— 78
Tol. Whitmer	15	11	10	24	— 60

Three-point goals: Southview — Remaklus, Rios 2; Tol. Whitmer — Alexander, Veres 2.
Junior varsity: Whitmer, 66-37.

O. Falls 62, Ottawa Glandorf 55

OTTAWA — The Bulldogs came roaring back, outscoring Ottawa-Glandorf 24-18 in the final quarter to pull out this non-conference win.

Falls	G	F	T
Jaroscak	1	0	2
Koch	0	5	5
Williams	10	3	23
Stanton	3	1	8
Retlier	1	0	2
Flores	2	0	4
Gansey	4	5	13
Schneider	1	0	2
Totals	23	14	62

Ottawa Glandorf	G	F	T
Schumaker	1	8	10
Pothast	1	0	2
McGlaughlin	7	2	20
Siefker	2	1	5
JSweet	1	2	5
Haselman	1	1	3
ESweet	5	0	10
Totals	18	5	55

Points by quarters

	1	2	3	4	T
O. Falls	11	16	11	24	— 62
O. Glandorf	8	16	13	18	— 55

Three-point goals: Falls — Williams 3, Stanton; Glandorf — McGlaughlin 4, Siefker.

Elyria, Southview grab Midview seeds

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

GRAFTON — Throw a hat over the field at the Midview Division I boys basketball tournament.

It's the best-balanced Division I field in years. Of the 13 teams entered, eight have winning marks and each team has won at least five games.

Pioneer Conference champion Medina (16-2) was the unanimous choice for top seed with defending district champion Brunswick (13-5) selected second. Lorain County rivals Southview (13-5) and Elyria (10-8) were seeded third and fourth, respectively.

"Overall I don't think it went too badly," said Jody Peters, coach of the top-seeded Bees. "Sometimes having the No. 1 seed is somewhat at a disadvantage. You have the first choice but after that you're at the mercy of how everybody else goes.

"I think it's a wide open tournament. I think there are a lot of decent teams. You have to show up to play. If you don't you could get beat. The No. 1 seed's only good on paper now. You have to go out and play."

DIVISION I DRAW

AT MIDVIEW HIGH SCHOOL

Seeds: 1. Medina, 2. Brunswick, 3. Southview, 4. Elyria.

Feb. 28
Lakewood vs. Strongsville, 7 p.m.

Feb. 29
North Olmsted vs. Amherst, 6 p.m.
Westlake vs. Admiral King, 7:45

March 1
Elyria vs. Cloverleaf, 6 p.m.
Midview vs. St. Edward, 7:45

March 3
Medina vs. Westlake-Admiral King, 6 p.m.
Southview vs. Lakewood-Strongsville, 7:45

March 4
Elyria-Cloverleaf vs. Midview-St. Edward, 6 p.m.
Brunswick vs. North Olmsted-Amherst, 7:45

March 8
Lakewood-Strongsville-Southview vs. Westlake-Admiral King-Medina, 7 p.m.

March 9
North Olmsted-Amherst-Brunswick vs. St. Edward-Midview-Elyria-Cloverleaf, 7 p.m.

March 11
District championship, 7 p.m.
Winner to Toledo Regional vs. Toledo District 1 winner

"I thought the third seed was a respect-type thing that we earned throughout the year," said Southview's Larry Stark. "We get the bye. I was happy with that."

Host Midview (15-2) garnered some votes for second, third and fourth seed, as did St. Edward (7-11), who drew the first pill. The Middies and Eagles are matched up in an intriguing first round game at 7:45 p.m. March 1. Elyria will play Cloverleaf (5-12) at 6 p.m. with the two winners facing off March 4 at 6 p.m.

"It couldn't have worked out any better for us, really," said Elyria coach John Srnis. "We're happy where we're at. It was interesting to see people staying away from us a little bit."

Srnis figured his team had a chance for a seed. It came down to receiving five votes from the field while four coaches selected Midview and St. Eds on the fourth seed ballot.

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